specific expertise of fashioning construction elements in *wood* would have evidently had no place in the exclusively brick and plaster architecture of the region (see above). Southern–central Ghur's building programs, then, seem altogether dissonant with mainly transhumant and nomadic ways of life.[46] Rather than constructing entirely new and compex built environments, the region's historical inhabitants' varying degrees of movement would instead have called for repairing, repurposing, and reusing inherited architectural landscapes.

During A. A. Kohzad's tours of central–southern Ghur in the mid-twentieth century, his local informants among the region's inhabitants, particularly in the Yaman Valley southeast of Taiwara, assigned notably different builders to the towers/fortifications, attributing virtually all the local ruins to the pre-Islamic centuries.[47] There may be a basis for these oral histories: one of the most noteworthy features of many of the region's ruined structures, whether sole towers or larger complexes, is their surface decoration (Figures 2.13–2.16). Based on first-hand docu-



Figure 2.13 *Ghor Province, Yahan, fortification tower, ruin, with decoration typical of region. © Photo by Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*